County of San Diego, Health and Human Services Agency (HHSA)
Medi-Cal Program Guide Special Notice

Family Members Base Allocation Amount for 2026-2027	**Number**	**Page**
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Effective Date:
July 1, 2026

Background:
The Family Members Base Allocation (FMBA) amount is updated annually per Section 1924(d) of the Social Security Act.

Purpose:
To inform staff of the new FMBA amount for 2026-2027.

Policy:
The FMBA amount is used when determining how much income an institutionalized or Home and Community-Based Services (HBCS) spouse may allocate to family members.

Refer to Medi-Cal Program Guide (MPG) 10.05.04 Allocation/Deeming and Special Case Situations for Long Term Care (LTC) and MPG 05.18.01 Home and Community-Based Services (HCBS).

Procedure:
Effective July 1, 2026, the updated FMBA amount of $2,705 must be used to calculate allocations to spouses and dependent family members of an institutionalized or HCBS spouse. Any allocations for the month of July and ongoing where the 2025-2026 amount of $2,644 was used must be recalculated.

Automation Impact:
Until the FMBA is updated in the California Statewide Automated Welfare System (CalSAWS), use a manual budget to calculate the FMBA and override to the appropriate aid code or Share of Cost (SOC). The manual budget must be imaged to the case record, and all case actions must be documented in a journal entry.

The following manual budgets for LTC cases are available in the CalSAWS Template Repository are:
- Allocation/Special Deduction Worksheet A (MC 176W).
- Share of Cost Determination MFBUs with LTC Person Included - LTC (MC 176M-LTC).

The following manual budget for HCBS cases is available in the Eligibility Forms Library (EFL):
- HHSA Budget Steps for HCBS Spousal Impoverishment (14-152).

References:
All County Welfare Directors Letter (ACWDL) 26-09

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 06/30/2027.

Approval for Release:


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Self-Sufficiency Services